4 Fill in the blanks with the past continuous or simple past forms of the given words.

1. Dad fell asleep while he was watching (watch) the movie.
2. I was taking a shower when you called (call).
3. I was driving (drive) home when I crashed my car.
4. The power went out while Faye was baking (bake) a cake.
5. He dropped (drop) his phone while he was getting off the subway.
6. The sun was shining (shine) when I woke up (wake up) this morning.
7. Rosie broke (break) her ankle while she was skating (skate).

5 Read the article. Use the words in the box to fill in the blanks.


lawn chair


weather balloon


power lines

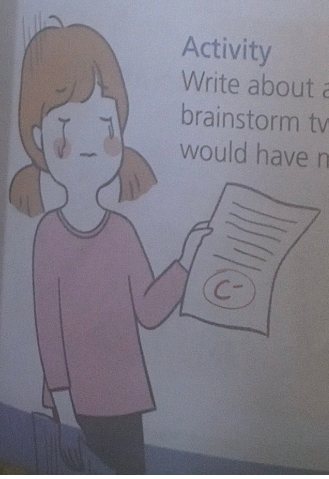

parachute

for got turned out was finally wasn't

"Lawn Chair Larry" wanted to fly. He'd tried to join the United States Air Force. However, Larry 1. wasn't able to become a pilot because of his problematic eyesight. Fortunately, Larry had another solution. First, he bought 45 eight-foot weather balloons. Next, he tied them to a lawn chair. 2. Finally, he was ready to take to the skies! He gathered his supplies: a parachute, a radio, a camera, and a small gun. His friends cut the cord, and he took off! It 3. turned out his plan worked! He 4. was flying at a height of 4,900 meters when pilots saw him. He drifted in the airport's direction and radioed down to the ground and told them he was OK. After he had been in the sky 5. for forty-five minutes, Larry shot some of the weather balloons. Unfortunately, he dropped his gun. Then, his balloons 6. got caught in a power line, causing a twenty-minute blackout. He landed safely but was immediately arrested by the police and fined $4,000. It was an event nobody will ever forget!

Writing

6 Read. Then copy the table onto a separate piece of paper and complete the activity.



Activity

Write about a problem you once had. Then write about how you solved that problem. Next, brainstorm two or more ways you could have solved your problem: one solution you think would have made things better and one that would have made things worse.

My problem	Ex. *I failed my math test.*
My solution	Ex. *I talked to my teacher and got extra help.*
My better solution	Ex. *I could have studied harder before the test.*
My worse solution	Ex. *I could have thrown the test in the garbage.*